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Wireless base station and wireless terminal

Abstract

Interference with another terminal caused by joint transmission of a plurality of wireless base stations is appropriately estimated. A wireless base station includes a wireless control section and a communication section. The wireless control section, when performing joint transmission with a joint wireless base station, generates a reference signal for estimating interference given to a wireless terminal connected to another wireless base station, and determines a setting regarding joint transmission in accordance with a result of estimation of interference based on the reference signal. The communication section transmits a reference signal to another wireless base station or a wireless terminal, and announces, to a joint wireless base station, a setting regarding joint transmission.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a U.S. National Phase of International Patent Application No. PCT/JP2021/000312 filed on Jan. 7, 2021, which claims priority benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. JP 2020-036687 filed in the Japan Patent Office on Mar. 4, 2020. Each of the above-referenced applications is hereby incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present technology relates to a wireless base station and a wireless terminal. Specifically, the present technology relates to a wireless base station and a wireless terminal in a wireless system including a plurality of wireless base stations that performs joint transmission.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) In a wireless LAN, in one basic service set (BSS), an access point (AP or BS) and a terminal (STA or UE) autonomously obtain a transmission right in the BSS, and perform communication. In a case where a plurality of antennas is mounted on a transmission terminal, transmission can be performed with a high gain to a desired destination terminal by transmission (beamforming (BF)) using a plurality of antennas simultaneously, and the system throughput in the BSS can be improved. In general, the gain obtained by beamforming is proportional to the number of antennas used simultaneously. By expanding the beamforming, the system throughput can be improved by transmission by a plurality of mutually cooperating APs (hereinafter, referred to as multiple APs).

(4) There is a plurality of schemes for multiple APs, and among them are coherent joint transmission (CJT) in which APs perform transmission as one virtual AP having antennas equivalent to the total number of all their antennas and non-coherent joint transmission (NCJT) in which APs perform transmission to a common reception terminal by forming beams independently in units of individual APs. These are roughly classified into joint transmission (JT) from multiple APs to a common destination terminal. Further, there is also coordinated nulling in which APs form nulls so that when performing communication with mutually different terminals by forming beams independently in units of individual APs, the APs do not interfere with each other's communication terminals. In an environment where there is a plurality of APs, all these schemes can achieve higher system throughput than in a case where cooperation is not performed among a plurality of APs.

(5) In NCJT and CJT, there is a problem that also interference with a terminal of another BSS that has a correlation in the propagation path with a desired destination terminal as viewed from the transmission terminal is increased and system throughput including other not-cooperating BSSs cannot be improved. In particular, in CJT, since a gain corresponding to the number of antennas of a plurality of APs is obtained, the increase in the amount of interference with other BSSs is more significant. Hence, in transmission by multiple APs, it is necessary to appropriately select the joint scheme in accordance with the propagation path in order to maximize the system throughput. For example, a technology in which potential interference in a communication system including a plurality of wireless devices is estimated and transmission is stopped or corrected is proposed (see, for example, Patent Document 1).

CITATION LIST

Patent Document

(6) Patent Document 1: Japanese National-Phase Publication No. 2019-528636

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Problems to be Solved by the Invention

(7) In the conventional technology described above, when estimating potential interference, a known beamforming training protocol is used, and it is difficult to reflect information regarding the propagation path. Therefore, there is a problem that it is difficult to appropriately estimate interference caused by joint transmission.

(8) The present technology has been made in view of such circumstances, and an object of the present technology is to appropriately estimate interference caused by joint transmission.

Solutions to Problems

(9) The present technology is provided to solve the above issues, and according to the first aspect of the present technology, there is provided a wireless base station including a wireless control section that generates a reference signal for estimating interference that is, when performing joint transmission with a joint wireless base station, given to a wireless terminal connected to another wireless base station and determines a setting regarding the joint transmission in accordance with a result of estimation of the interference based on the reference signal, and a communication section that transmits the reference signal to the another wireless base station or the wireless terminal and announces the setting regarding the joint transmission to the joint wireless base station. This brings about an action that the joint scheme is determined according to a result of estimation of interference and is notified to a joint wireless base station.

(10) Further, in the first aspect, the wireless control section may inquire of the another wireless base station whether or not measurement for estimation of the interference can be performed prior to transmission of the reference signal. This brings about an action in which before measurement of interference estimation is performed, whether or not the

measurement can be performed is inquired of another wireless base station.

(11) Further, in the first aspect, the wireless control section may generate information regarding precoding of the reference signal, and the communication section may transmit the information regarding precoding of the reference signal to the joint wireless base station. This brings about an action in which information regarding precoding is transmitted to a joint wireless base station.

(12) Further, in the first aspect, the information regarding precoding may include information regarding a frequency at which the reference signal is used, information regarding a codebook predetermined with the joint wireless base station, and information regarding a weighting factor to be calculated to the reference signal.

(13) Further, in the first aspect, the information regarding precoding may include information regarding a time offset for the joint wireless base station at a time of transmission of the reference signal. In this case, the information regarding precoding may include at least one piece of information indicating presence or absence of the time offset or information indicating the time offset.

(14) Further, in the first aspect, the wireless control section, prior to transmission of the reference signal, may generate information indicating that measurement for estimation of the interference is to be implemented, and the communication section may transmit, to the another wireless base station, the information indicating that measurement for estimation of the interference is to be implemented. This brings about an action in which, prior to the transmission of a reference signal, it is announced that measurement for interference estimation is to be implemented. In this case, the information indicating that measurement for estimation of the interference is to be implemented may include information regarding a time to transmit the reference signal, an implementation period of the measurement, and a frequency at which the measurement is implemented.

(15) Further, in the first aspect, the wireless control section may determine a joint parameter including at least one of a joint transmission scheme, precoding, an encoding scheme, or transmission power in the joint transmission on the basis of a result of estimation of the interference from the another wireless base station. In this case, the joint parameter is determined on the basis of a predetermined criterion.

(16) Further, in the first aspect, the reference signal may include information for estimating a propagation path between the wireless base station and a wireless terminal connected to the wireless base station, and the communication section may transmit the reference signal to the wireless terminal connected to the wireless base station. This brings about an action in which a propagation path is estimated in parallel with interference estimation.

(17) Further, in the first aspect, the setting of the joint transmission announced by the communication section may include information regarding a number of the joint wireless base stations. Furthermore, the setting of the joint transmission announced by the communication section may further include at least one of information regarding a joint transmission scheme in the joint transmission, information regarding a transmission antenna to be used in the joint wireless base station, information regarding the wireless terminal of a destination in the joint transmission, or information regarding precoding of the wireless terminal of a destination in the joint transmission. Furthermore, the information regarding precoding of the wireless terminal of a destination in the joint transmission may include information regarding a number of the wireless terminals of destinations, information that identifies the wireless terminal of a destination, and information regarding a frequency, an encoding scheme, transmission power, and a stream to be used in the joint transmission.

(18) Further, according to the second aspect of the present technology, there is provided a wireless base station including a wireless control section that acquires, from a wireless terminal, information regarding interference with the wireless terminal caused by joint transmission, the interference having been estimated by using a reference signal supplied from any one of a plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission, and generates overall interference information on the basis of the acquired information regarding the interference, and a communication section that transmits the overall interference information to any one of the plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission. This brings about an action in which overall interference information is generated on the basis of individual interference information acquired from a wireless terminal and is transmitted to any one of a plurality of wireless base stations that performs joint transmission.

(19) Further, in the second aspect, the communication section may request each of the plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission to transmit a reference signal for estimating interference given to the wireless terminal because of the joint transmission. This brings about an action that interference estimation is performed with request from other than party to joint transmission as an opportunity.

(20) Further, according to the third aspect of the present technology, there is provided a wireless terminal including a wireless control section that estimates interference received because of joint transmission by using a reference signal supplied from any one of a plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission, and a communication section that transmits information regarding the estimated interference to another wireless base station. This brings about an action in which a wireless terminal estimates interference received by itself because of joint transmission and transmits the result as individual interference information to a wireless base station.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. **1** is a diagram showing a configuration example of a wireless network system in an embodiment of the present technology.
- (2) FIG. **2** is a diagram showing a configuration example of a wireless communication apparatus **300** in an embodiment of the present technology.
- (3) FIG. **3** is a sequence diagram showing an operation example of a wireless network system in a first embodiment of the present technology.
- (4) FIG. **4** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan announcement **811** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (5) FIG. **5** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan response **812** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (6) FIG. **6** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT scan sector information **813** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (7) FIG. **7** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan trigger **815** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (8) FIG. **8** is a diagram showing a configuration example of a data unit announced by a JT interference scan **818** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (9) FIG. **9** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference report **823** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (10) FIG. **10** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of JT interference feedback **824** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (11) FIG. **11** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a joint transmission setting announcement **827** in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (12) FIG. **12** is a flowchart showing a processing procedure example of weight determination processing in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (13) FIG. **13** is a flowchart showing a processing procedure example of joint transmission setting determination processing in the first embodiment of the present technology.
- (14) FIG. **14** is a sequence diagram showing an operation example of a wireless network system in a second embodiment of the present technology.
- (15) FIG. **15** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan trigger **831** in the second embodiment of the present technology.
- (16) FIG. **16** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of channel feedback **834** in the second embodiment of the present technology.
- (17) FIG. **17** is a flowchart showing a processing procedure example of weight determination processing in the second embodiment of the present technology.
- (18) FIG. **18** is a sequence diagram showing an operation example of a wireless network system in a third embodiment of the present technology.
- (19) FIG. **19** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan request **841** in the third embodiment of the present technology.
- (20) FIG. **20** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan announcement **842** in the third embodiment of the present technology.

MODE FOR CARRYING OUT THE INVENTION

- (21) Hereinbelow, modes for implementing the present technology (hereinafter, referred to as embodiments) are described. The description is given in the following order.
- (22) 1. First embodiment (example in which interference caused by joint transmission is estimated on the basis of reference signal)
- (23) 2. Second embodiment (example in which channel estimation is performed in parallel with interference estimation)
- (24) 3. Third embodiment (example in which interference estimation is performed with request from other than party to joint transmission as an opportunity)
1. First Embodiment
- (25) [Wireless Network System]
- (26) FIG. **1** is a diagram showing a configuration example of a wireless network system in an embodiment of the present technology.
- (27) Herein, joint transmission in which simultaneous transmission is cooperatively implemented from a master access point (master AP or sharing AP) **101** and a slave access point (slave AP or shared AP) **102** to a wireless terminal (STA) **108** or **109** is supposed. Further, it is also possible to simultaneously communicate with the wireless terminals **108** and **109**. Note that the master access point **101** and the slave access point **102** that perform joint transmission are collectively referred to as multiple APs. Further, a master AP and a slave AP may not be determined in a fixed manner on APs, but may be determined in a dynamic manner among multiple APs. For example, AP **1** may be a master AP and AP **2** may be a slave AP at a certain time t_1 , and AP **1** may be a slave AP and AP **2** may be a master AP at a different time t_2 .

(28) In basic service set A (BSS-A), multiple APs and wireless terminals **108** and **109** are connected. Area **10** is a radio wave coverage area in a case where the multiple APs perform non-JT transmission. Area **11** is a radio wave coverage area in a case where the multiple APs perform JT transmission.

(29) Basic service set B (BSS-B) is a BSS having an overlapped area as viewed from BSS-A, that is, an overlapped BSS (OBSS). In BSS-B, an OBSS access point (OBSS-AP) **203** and an OBSS terminal (OBSS-STA) **209** are connected. Area **20** is the coverage area of radio waves from the OBSS access point **203**.

(30) It is assumed that the OBSS access point **203** and the multiple APs have a relationship in which they can perform mutual transmission. Further, for the radio wave coverage areas of BSS-A and BSS-B, those for the same frequency channel are shown.

(31) Note that although herein an example in which the OBSS access point **203** is present within a radio wave coverage area in non-JT transmission from the multiple APs of BSS-A is shown, the OBSS access point does not necessarily need to be present within a radio wave coverage area in non-JT transmission. For example, any AP of BSS-A (the master AP **101** or the slave AP **102**) and the OBSS access point **203** may be connected by wire, or further, may be within radio wave coverage areas in mutually different frequency channels.

(32) [Device Configuration]

(33) FIG. **2** is a diagram showing a configuration example of a wireless communication apparatus **300** in an embodiment of the present technology. The wireless communication apparatus **300** shown here includes a master AP **101**, a slave AP **102**, an OBSS-AP **203**, wireless terminals **108** and **109**, and an OBSS terminal **209**. Further, for example, the wireless communication apparatus **300** may be wireless communication modules or integrated circuits mounted on the APs and the terminals.

(34) The wireless communication apparatus **300** includes a communication section **310**, a control section **321**, a power source section **322**, and antennas **319**. There may be a plurality of communication sections **310**.

(35) The communication section **310** includes a wireless control section **311**, a data processing section **312**, a modulation/demodulation section **313**, a signal processing section **314**, a channel estimation section **315**, wireless interface sections **316**, and amplifier sections **317**. The wireless interface section **316**, the amplifier section **317**, and the antenna **319** may form one set, and one or more sets may form a constituent component. Further, the function of the amplifier section **317** may be included in the wireless interface section **316**. The communication section **310** is obtained by, for example, large scale integration (LSI).

(36) At the time of transmission in which data is inputted from a higher layer, the data processing section **312** generates a packet for wireless transmission from the data, implements processing such as addition of a header for media access control (MAC) or addition of an error detection symbol, and supplies the processed data to the modulation/demodulation section **313**. On the other hand, at the time of reception in which there is an input from the modulation/demodulation section **313**, the data processing section **312** implements MAC header analysis, packet error detection, reorder processing, etc., and provides the processed data to a protocol higher layer of itself.

(37) The wireless control section **311** performs the exchange of information among the sections. Further, the wireless control section **311** performs parameter setting in the modulation/demodulation section **313** and the signal processing section **314**, packet scheduling in the data processing section **312**, and parameter setting and transmission power control of the modulation/demodulation section **313**, the signal processing section **314**, the wireless interface section **316**, and the amplifier section **317**.

(38) At the time of transmission, the modulation/demodulation section **313** performs encoding, interleaving, and modulation on input data from the data processing section **312** on the basis of an encoding scheme and a modulation scheme set by the wireless control section **311**, generates a data symbol stream, and supplies the data symbol stream to the signal processing section **314**. At the time of reception, the modulation/demodulation section **313** performs reverse processing to that at the time of transmission on an input from the signal processing section **314**, and supplies data to the data processing section **312** or the wireless control section **311**.

(39) At the time of transmission, the signal processing section **314** performs signal processing used for spatial separation on an input from the modulation/demodulation section **313** as necessary, and supplies the obtained one or more transmission symbol streams to each wireless interface section **316**. Note that transmission (hereinafter, cyclic shift delay (CSD)) may be applied while spatial separation is not performed and arbitrary amount of delay are given to the antennas **319** individually. Further, at the time of reception, the signal processing section **314** performs signal processing on a reception symbol stream inputted from each wireless interface section **316**, performs spatial resolution of the stream as necessary, and supplies the result to the modulation/demodulation section **313**.

(40) The channel estimation section **315** calculates complex channel gain information of a propagation path from a preamble portion and a training signal portion of an input signal from each wireless interface section **316**. The calculated complex channel gain information is used for demodulation processing in the modulation/demodulation section **313** and spatial processing in the signal processing section **314** via the wireless control section **311**.

(41) At the time of transmission, the wireless interface section **316** converts an input from the signal processing section **314** to an analog signal, implements filtering, up-conversion to a carrier frequency, and phase control, and transmits the result to the antenna **319** or the amplifier section **317**. At the time of reception, the wireless interface section **316** implements reverse processing on an input from the antenna **319** or the amplifier section **317**, and supplies data to the signal processing section **314** and the channel estimation section **315**.

(42) At the time of transmission, the amplifier section **317** amplifies an analog signal inputted from the wireless interface section **316** to a predetermined power, and transmits the result to the antenna **319**. At the time of reception, the amplifier section **317** amplifies a signal inputted from the antenna **319** to a predetermined power, and outputs the result to the wireless interface section **316**. All or part of at least one of the functions at the time of transmission or the function at the time of reception of the amplifier section **317** may be included in the wireless interface section **316**. Further, all or part of at least one of the functions at the time of transmission or the function at the time of reception of the amplifier section **317** may be a constituent component outside the communication section **310**.

(43) The control section **321** controls the wireless control section **311** and the power source section **322**. Further, the control section **321** may, in place of the wireless control section **311**, implement at least part of the operation of the wireless control section **311**.

(44) The power source section **322** includes a battery power source or a fixed power source, and supplies power to each section of the wireless communication apparatus **300**.

(45) Among these configurations, the wireless control section **311** and the control section **321** control each section to perform the following operation.

(46) [Operation]

(47) FIG. **3** is a sequence diagram showing an operation example of a wireless network system in a first embodiment of the present technology.

(48) Herein, access points (a master AP **101** and a slave AP **102**) and a wireless terminal **109** included in a first BSS are supposed. Further, an access point, OBSS-AP **203** and an OBSS terminal **209** included in a second BSS (hereinafter, an overlapped BSS (OBSS)) are supposed.

(49) [JT Interference Scan Announcement]

(50) First, the master AP **101** performs, on the OBSS-AP **203**, an announcement (JT interference scan announcement) **811** that requests a response as to whether or not the multiple APs can execute interference measurement on the OBSS terminal **209**. At this time, information indicating the start time and the execution period of interference measurement may be included in the announcement. Further, the JT interference scan announcement on the OBSS-AP **203** may be performed by at least one of the master AP **101** or the slave AP **102**.

(51) The JT interference scan announcement **811** may be executed after it is determined that the multiple APs implement joint transmission **828**. However, it is not necessary to implement the JT interference scan announcement **811** every time for each joint transmission. This is because although the amount of interference with the OBSS is to be estimated in the later performed JT interference feedback **824**, in a case where the time variation of the propagation path is relatively long with respect to the period of joint transmission, information highly correlated with information of the amount of interference acquired in the immediately preceding JT interference feedback **824** can be obtained, and thus even if past information is utilized, the impact on the characteristics will be small.

(52) For example, if the multiple APs hold an interference estimation result based on previously-implemented JT interference feedback **824** and it is within the period during which the propagation path can be considered to be constant, the JT interference scan announcement **811** is not executed and the procedure may start from joint scheme determination or the like (**826**).

(53) Further, similarly, if it is outside the period during which the propagation path can be considered to be constant and the multiple APs recognize the presence of an OBSS, the JT interference scan announcement **811** may be executed. Note that the JT interference scan announcement **811** is an example of a wireless control section mentioned in the claims.

(54) [JT Interference Scan Response]

(55) The OBSS-AP **203** that has received a request for response as to whether or not interference measurement can be executed performs, on the master AP **101**, an announcement (JT interference scan response) **812** of whether interference measurement can be executed or not. At this time, a start time and an execution period of interference measurement acceptable to the OBSS-AP **203** may be included in the announcement. Further, the OBSS-AP **203** may notify at least one of the master AP **101** or the slave AP **102**.

(56) Depending on the situation, such as a case where only the slave AP **102** is designated as the destination of response announcement from the OBSS-AP **203** or a case where communication quality between the OBSS-AP **203** and the master AP **101** is low, there is a case where only the slave AP **102** receives a response from the OBSS-AP **203**. In this case, the slave AP **102** may transfer the response information received from the OBSS-AP **203** to the master AP **101**.

(57) The master AP **101** notified of a response as to executability from the OBSS-AP **203** determines whether or not to implement interference measurement on the OBSS on the basis of the received information.

(58) Note that in a case of announcing only whether or not the interference measurement can be executed in response to the information announced by the JT interference scan announcement **811** implemented from the multiple APs, an Ack frame or a block Ack frame prescribed in IEEE 802.11 may be sent.

(59) [JT Scan Sector Information]

(60) In a case where the master AP **101** has determined to implement interference measurement, the master AP **101** executes, on the slave AP **102**, an announcement of information (JT scan sector information) **813** for executing interference measurement. This information includes information indicating the start time and the execution period of interference measurement, and a weighting factor for multiplication for an antenna used at the time of interference measurement and a value of cyclic shift delay (hereinafter, precoding), but is not limited thereto.

(61) Further, in a case where the master AP **101** has determined to implement interference measurement, the master AP **101** may notify the slave AP **102** of information indicating the start time and the execution period of interference measurement on the OBSS-AP **203**. Note that the JT scan sector information **813** is an example of a communication section mentioned in the claims.

(62) The slave AP **102** that has received information for executing interference measurement from the master AP **101** notifies the master AP **101** of information (Ack) **814** indicating the reception. Ack **814** may be announced as a block Ack prescribed in IEEE 802.11, as necessary.

(63) Note that the slave AP **102** may notify the master AP **101** of, together with Ack **814**, information indicating a start time that the slave AP **102** requests. In this case, in a case where the master AP **101** notified of a request of the start time from the slave AP **102** changes the start time, the master AP **101** may execute an announcement of the JT scan sector information **813** again.

(64) [JT Interference Scan Trigger]

(65) In a case where the master AP **101** that has received Ack **814** from the slave AP **102** has determined that the start time of interference measurement is approaching, the master AP **101** executes, on the OBSS-AP **203**, an information announcement (JT interference scan trigger) **815** indicating that interference measurement is to be implemented. At this time, the information announcement may include information indicating the start time and the execution period for implementing interference measurement, but is not limited thereto. Note that the JT interference scan trigger **815** is an example of a communication section mentioned in the claims.

(66) Note that in a case where the master AP **101** has determined that it is difficult for the JT interference scan trigger **815** to be correctly received by the OBSS-AP **203**, such as a case where communication quality between the master AP **101** and the OBSS-AP **203** is low, the JT interference scan trigger **815** may be announced from both the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**, or only the slave AP **102**.

(67) Further, although the start time of interference measurement is the time indicated by the JT scan sector information **813**, the start time may be determined by the master AP **101** on the basis of information announced together with Ack **814** from the slave AP **102**.

(68) [OBSS-JT Interference Scan Announcement]

(69) The OBSS-AP **203** that has received, from at least one of the master AP **101** or the slave AP **102**, information indicating that interference measurement is to be implemented executes, on the OBSS terminal **209**, an information announcement (OBSS JT interference scan announcement) **816** indicating that interference measurement is to be implemented from the multiple APs. The information announced by the OBSS JT interference scan announcement **816** may be information indicating the start time and the execution period for implementing interference measurement, but is not limited thereto.

(70) [JT Interference Scan]

(71) After the JT interference scan trigger **815** indicating that interference measurement is to be implemented is executed on the OBSS-AP **203**, the multiple APs that have determined that it is time to start interference measurement perform, on the OBSS terminal **209**, an announcement (JT interference scan) **818** of information including a reference signal of interference measurement. At this time, the reference signal is transmitted by precoding predetermined among the multiple APs. The precoding may be determined on the basis of a discrete Fourier transformation (DFT) matrix or information announced in advance by the master AP **101** to the slave AP **102**. Further, a plurality of pieces of precoding may be applied in a time division manner. Note that the JT interference scan **818** is an example of a communication section mentioned in the claims.

(72) The OBSS terminal **209** that has received a reference signal of interference measurement from the multiple APs estimates the amount of interference for each observed piece of precoding (**821**). The amount of interference for precoding is calculated as received power, but may be calculated by other techniques.

(73) Note that, immediately before implementing the JT interference scan **818**, the multiple APs may execute a trigger **817** announcing that the JT interference scan **818** is to be implemented.

(74) [JT Interference Report Trigger and JT Interference Report]

(75) After the transmission of a reference signal for interference measurement from the multiple APs to the OBSS terminal **209** is ended, the OBSS terminal **209** executes, on the OBSS-AP **203**, an information announcement (JT interference report) **823** indicating the estimated amount of interference observed. At this time, this may be executed after a request (JT interference report trigger) **822** for transmission of the estimated amount of interference is announced from the OBSS-AP **203**. Note that the JT interference report **823** is an example of a communication section or a wireless control section mentioned in the claims.

(76) Note that in a case where there is a plurality of OBSS terminals **209**, the JT interference report **823** may be executed by the orthogonal frequency domain multiple access (OFDMA) scheme. In this case, the JT interference report trigger **822** may include information indicating the frequency that each OBSS terminal **209** uses in OFDMA.

(77) [JT Interference Feedback]

(78) The OBSS-AP **203** to which information indicating the estimated amount of interference observed has been announced from all desired OBSS terminals **209** executes, on the multiple APs, an announcement (JT interference feedback) **824** of information indicating the results of the estimated amount of interference. Note that although this example shows a case where the master AP **101** is notified, notification may be performed to at least one of the master

AP **101** or the slave AP **102**. Note that the JT interference feedback **824** is an example of a result of estimation of interference from another wireless base station, or a communication section mentioned in the claims.

(79) The multiple APs to which information indicating the result of the estimated amount of interference has been announced from the OBSS-AP **203** notify the OBSS-AP **203** of Ack **825**. Ack **825** may be announced as a block Ack prescribed in IEEE 802.11, as necessary. Further, although this example shows a case where the master AP **101** notifies the OBSS-AP **203**, at least one of the master AP **101** or the slave AP **102** may announce Ack **825**.

(80) [Joint Transmission Setting Determination]

(81) The master AP **101** that has received information indicating the result of the estimated amount of interference from the OBSS-AP **203** performs determination **826** of a setting regarding joint transmission with the slave AP **102** on the basis of the information announced. The setting regarding a joint scheme includes at least one of a joint transmission scheme with the slave AP **102**, precoding in joint transmission with the slave AP **102**, or scheduling including transmission power and a modulation and coding scheme (MCS) in joint transmission with the slave AP **102**.

(82) [Joint Transmission Setting Announcement]

(83) The master AP **101** that has performed the determination **826** of a setting regarding joint transmission executes, on the slave AP **102**, an information announcement (joint transmission setting announcement: JT scheme announcement) **827** indicating a setting regarding joint transmission of the slave AP **102**. Note that the joint transmission setting announcement **827** is an example of a communication section mentioned in the claims.

(84) The slave AP **102** that has received the joint transmission setting announcement **827** from the master AP **101** may notify the master AP **101** of an Ack. This Ack may be announced as a block Ack prescribed in IEEE 802.11, as necessary.

(85) If the setting regarding joint transmission is completed by the joint transmission setting announcement **827**, the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102** perform joint transmission (coordinated transmission) **828** on the basis of the setting. At this time, the OBSS-AP **203** can transmit data **829** to the OBSS terminal **209** independently of joint transmission by the multiple APs.

(86) [Frame Configuration]

(87) In the following, the configurations of the frames, etc. described in the above sequence diagram are described in detail.

(88) [JT Interference Scan Announcement]

(89) FIG. **4** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan announcement **811** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(90) The JT interference scan announcement **811** is used for the multiple APs announcing, to the OBSS-AP **203** of an interference measurement target, the start time and the execution period in a case where the multiple APs execute the JT interference scan **818** and requesting a response of request values of the OBSS-AP **203** regarding the start time and the execution period. This frame includes "Frame Control" and "JT Interference Scan Announcement element" as shown below, but is not limited thereto.

(91) The "Frame Control" includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference scan announcement **811**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the "Frame Control" alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference scan announcement **811** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the "JT Interference Scan Announcement element" may be applied.

(92) The "JT Interference Scan Announcement element" includes at least one of the fields of "Element ID", "Frequency Band", "Number of Multiple APs", "Scan Start Time", and "Scan Execution Period".

(93) The "Element ID" includes information indicating that this element is a JT interference scan announcement element and information indicating the bit length of this element. Note that each of the "Element ID"s shown hereinafter includes information indicating similar information to the above-described "Element ID". However, in a case where a certain element is determined to be necessarily present, the "Element ID" of this element may be omitted.

(94) The "Frequency Band" (band width (BW)) includes information indicating a request value of the frequency band in which the multiple APs implement the JT interference scan **818**. The "Number of Multiple APs" (Multi AP Number) includes information indicating the number of access points that execute the JT interference scan **818**. The "Scan Start Time" includes information indicating the start time of the JT interference scan **818** requested by the multiple APs. The "Scan Execution Period" (Scan Duration) includes information indicating the execution period of the JT interference scan **818** requested by the multiple APs.

(95) [JT Interference Scan Response]

(96) FIG. **5** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of the JT interference scan response **812** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(97) The JT interference scan response **812** is used so that the OBSS-AP **203** on which the JT interference scan announcement **811** has been executed by the multiple APs announces information regarding the execution of the JT interference scan **818**, such as whether or not the JT interference scan **818** can be performed, and the start time and the execution period, on the basis of the information announced. This frame includes "Frame Control" and "JT Interference Scan Response element" as shown below, but is not limited thereto.

(98) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference scan response **812**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference scan response **812** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Scan Response element” may be applied.

(99) The “JT Interference Scan Response element” includes at least one or more of the fields of “Element ID”, “Frequency Band”, “Number of Terminals”, “Scan Grant”, “Scan Start Time”, and “Scan Execution Period”.

(100) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating a frequency band that the OBSS-AP **203** requests in regard to the frequency band that the multiple APs use in the JT interference scan **818**. The “Number of Terminals” (STA Number) includes information indicating the number of wireless terminals connected to the OBSS-AP **203** present in the OBSS. The “Scan Grant” includes information indicating, to the multiple APs, a request by the OBSS-AP **203** as to whether or not the JT interference scan **818** can be executed. The “Scan Start Time” includes information indicating a start time that the OBSS-AP **203** requests in regard to the JT interference scan **818** to be implemented by the multiple APs. The “Scan Execution Period” (Scan Duration) includes information indicating an execution period of the JT interference scan **818** that the OBSS-AP **203** requests in regard to the JT interference scan **818** to be implemented by the multiple APs.

(101) Note that the multiple APs that have received the JT interference scan response **812** may determine whether or not the JT interference scan **818** can be implemented on the basis of information indicated by the “Number of Terminals”. Further, in a case where the “Scan Grant” includes information indicating to the multiple APs that the execution of the JT interference scan **818** is rejected, neither the “Scan Start Time” nor the “Scan Execution Period” may be present.

(102) [JT Scan Sector Information]

(103) FIG. **6** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of the JT scan sector information **813** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(104) The JT scan sector information **813** is used to announce, from the master AP **101** to the slave AP **102**, information necessary to implement the JT interference scan **818**. This frame includes “Frame Control”, “JT Interference Scan Control element”, and “JT Interference Scan Information element” as shown below, but is not limited thereto. Note that the “JT Interference Scan Control element” and the “JT Interference Scan Information element” may be collectively defined as one element without being separated.

(105) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT scan sector information **813**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT scan sector information **813** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Scan Control element” may be applied.

(106) The “JT Interference Scan Control element” includes information for estimating each field length in the subsequent “JT Interference Scan Information element” in advance, but is not limited thereto. This element includes at least one or more of the fields of “Frequency Band”, “Scan Sector Information”, and “Time Synchronization” in addition to “Element ID”.

(107) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating the frequency band in which the JT interference scan **818** is implemented. The “Scan Sector Information” includes information indicating the number, form, and format of each “Sector ID” field in the subsequent “JT Interference Scan Information element”. The “Time Synchronization” (Time Sync) includes information regarding the transmission timing between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102** in a case where the JT interference scan **818** is implemented by the multiple APs. Note that the “Time Synchronization” is an example of information regarding a time offset mentioned in the claims.

(108) The “Scan Sector Information” includes at least one or more of the subfields of “Sector Number”, “Slave AP Antenna Mask”, “Codebook Information”, “Slave AP Index”, and “Quantization Granularity”.

(109) The “Sector Number” includes information indicating the number of pieces of precoding used in the JT interference scan **818**. The “Slave AP Antenna Mask” (Slave AP Ant Mask) includes information indicating the antenna of the slave AP **102** used in the JT interference scan **818**. In a case where a candidate for precoding used to implement the JT interference scan **818** is predetermined between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**, the “Codebook Information” includes information indicating whether or not to use the precoding candidate. The “Slave AP Index” (Slave AP Nr Index) includes information specifying, among precoding candidates, a range applied to each slave AP **102**. The “Quantization Granularity” includes information indicating how many bits of information each numerical value included in precoding is expressed by.

(110) For precoding, a plurality of kinds of precoding is announced, and information indicating each kind is stored in the respective “Sector ID” field in the subsequent “JT Interference Scan Information element”. For example, in a case where precoding candidates are predetermined as a DFT matrix between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**, information indicating the row number of a piece of precoding to be used by a slave AP **102** among the precoding candidates is stored in the “Slave AP Index”. On the other hand, in a case where precoding candidates are not determined between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**, it is necessary to announce a precoding matrix, and the “Quantization Granularity” is used to grasp a precoding matrix from information stored in the “Sector ID” field.

(111) Further, the “Time Synchronization” includes at least one or more of the subfields of “Flag” and “Time”.

(112) The “Flag” includes information indicating whether or not, in a case where the multiple APs implement the JT interference scan **818**, the transmission timing should be shifted between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**. In a case where the “Flag” includes information indicating that the JT interference scan **818** is to be implemented with the transmission timing shifted, the “Time” includes information indicating the value of the shift in transmission timing. (113) Note that the “Flag” and the “Time” may be implemented as follows. That is, for example, a case of setting of “1” in the “Flag” may indicate that the transmission timing is shifted between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**, and the transmission timing may be read in accordance with information indicated by the “Time”. Further, for example, a setting of “0” in the “Time” may indicate that transmission is performed simultaneously without shifting the timing between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**. Note that the “Flag” is an example of information indicating the presence or absence of a time offset mentioned in the claims. Further, the “Time” is an example of information indicating a time offset mentioned in the claims.

(114) The “JT Interference Scan Information element” includes detailed information of precoding used in the JT interference scan **818** that is not included in the “JT Interference Scan Control element”, but is not limited thereto. This element includes the fields of “Sector ID”s in addition to “Element ID”.

(115) The “Sector ID” includes information indicating a precoding matrix. There is a total of Nscan “Sector ID” fields; Nscan is determined on the basis of the value of the “Sector Number” subfield in the “JT Interference Scan Control element”. The information indicated by the “Sector ID” is used in the JT interference scan **818** when the multiple APs generate TRN, which is a sequence for estimating the amount of interference, and is information indicating Q described later. Note that the “Slave AP Index”, the “Quantization Granularity”, and the “Sector ID” are examples of a weighting factor mentioned in the claims.

(116) [JT Interference Scan Trigger]

(117) FIG. 7 is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference scan trigger **815** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(118) The JT interference scan trigger **815** is used when announcing, from the multiple APs to the OBSS-AP **203**, information indicating the timing at which the JT interference scan **818** is implemented. This frame includes “Frame Control” and “JT Interference Scan Information” as shown below, but is not limited thereto.

(119) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference scan trigger **815**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference scan trigger **815** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Scan Information” may be applied.

(120) The “JT Interference Scan Information” includes information indicating the timing at which the JT interference scan **818** is implemented, but is not limited thereto. This field includes the subfields of “Frequency Band”, “Scan Start Time”, and “Scan Execution Period”, but is not limited thereto.

(121) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating the frequency channel on which the multiple APs implement the JT interference scan **818**. The “Scan Start Time” includes information regarding the time at which the multiple APs implement the JT interference scan **818**. The “Scan Execution Period” (Scan Duration) includes information indicating the period during which the multiple APs implement the JT interference scan **818**. Note that the “Scan Start Time” is an example of information regarding a time to transmit a reference signal, which is mentioned in the claims. Further, the “Scan Execution Period” is an example of information regarding an execution period of measurement mentioned in the claims. Further, the “Frequency Band” is an example of information regarding a frequency at which measurement is implemented, which is mentioned in the claims.

(122) [JT Interference Scan]

(123) FIG. 8 is a diagram showing a configuration example of a data unit announced by a JT interference scan **818** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(124) This data unit is transmitted from the multiple APs to the OBSS terminal **209** in order to estimate the amount of interference. This data unit includes the fields of “Legacy”, “EHT-SIG”, “EHT-STF”, “EHT-LTF”, and “TRN #1” to “TRN #N”, but is not limited thereto.

(125) The “Legacy” is used to, at the time of receiving this data unit, perform time synchronization and frequency synchronization, and estimate propagation path information necessary when demodulating a subsequent frame. This may be a sequence that is known among transmission/reception terminals in advance. Note that this may be used for purposes other than these.

(126) The “EHT-SIG” includes information indicating the number of subsequent “TRN #1” to “TRN #N” fields and information regarding the inside of each “TRN” field. Note that the constituent components of the “EHT-SIG” are not limited thereto. The “EHT-SIG” includes at least one of the fields of “TRN Length”, “Number of TRNs”, “Number of Pieces of Precoding”, and “Subcarrier Allocation”.

(127) The “TRN Length” includes information regarding the total number of bits of the subsequent “TRN #1” to “TRN #N”. The “Number of TRNs” (TRN Number) includes information regarding the subfield length of the “Interference Estimation Field (IEF)” in each “TRN” field. The “Number of Pieces of Precoding” (Precoding Number) includes information regarding precoding used in the subsequent “TRN”. The “Subcarrier Allocation” includes information necessary to, when a plurality of pieces of precoding is multiplexed in the “IEF” in the subsequent “TRN” field,

demultiplex the plurality of pieces of precoding. Note that the “Number of Pieces of Precoding” may include information indicating the number of pieces of precoding used in the subsequent “IEF”. Further, the “Subcarrier Allocation” may include information indicating the subcarrier allocated to each piece of precoding.

(128) The “EHT-STF” and the “EHT-LTF” are used to perform time synchronization and frequency synchronization together with the “Legacy”. Similarly to the “Legacy”, each of these may be a sequence that is known among transmission/reception terminals in advance, and the use is not limited to these purposes.

(129) Each of the “TRN #1” to the “TRN #N” is a training sequence used in the OBSS terminal **209** to estimate the amount of interference for an arbitrary piece of precoding. Each “TRN” field includes “IEF” that is a known sequence for estimating the amount of interference in the OBSS terminal **209**, but the constituent components are not limited thereto.

(130) The “IEF” (Interference Estimation Field) includes a sequence that estimates the amount of interference for an arbitrary piece of precoding in the OBSS terminal **209**. The “IEF” of the “TRN #L” may be the known sequence shown below.

[Math. 1]

$$(131) \quad r_{\text{TRN}\#L}(q) = \frac{r_{\text{TRN}\#L}(1, q)}{r_{\text{TRN}\#L}(\text{numel}(r_m), q)} = \frac{1}{K} \cdot \text{Math.} \left[\begin{matrix} N_p(L) \\ i=1 \end{matrix} \right] \cdot \text{Math.} \left[\begin{matrix} N_f(i) \\ j=1 \end{matrix} \right] Q_{c(L,i)}^{(r_m)} e^{-j2\pi f_{k(ij)}q} \quad \text{Formula1} \quad q = 0, 1, \dots, N_{\text{DFT}} - 1$$

(132) Here, m is a number representing an access point included in the multiple APs. L is an ordinal number of “TRN”. r.sub.TRN #L.sup.(m)(k,q) represents, for the m-th access point, a transmission signal of a baseband at a discrete time q of the k-th antenna that transmits the L-th “TRN” field.

(133) Here, Q.sub.c(L,i).sup.(rm) refers to, for the matrix indicated by Q below, the c(L,i)-th column and rows indicated by rm. The column vector q.sub.1 or the like of Q is referred to as a precoding vector.

$Q = [q_1 \ q_2 \ \dots \ q_{\text{sub.NDFT}-1}]$

(134) Further, c(L,i) is the column number of a precoding vector multiplexed in the “IEF” of the “TRN #L”. rm is a row number group of a precoding vector allocated to the m-th access point among the access points included in the multiple APs. numel(rm) is the number of elements of rm. K is a normalization coefficient. Np(L) is the number of precoding vectors simultaneously applied in the “IEF” in the L-th “TRN” subfield. Nf(i) is the number of subcarriers to which the c(L,i)-th precoding vector is applied. ki(j) is the j-th subcarrier to which the c(L,i)-th precoding vector is applied. NDFT is the number of points of inverse discrete Fourier transformation (IDFT) used in the OFDM modulation scheme. q represents a discrete time.

(135) Specific examples of Q are shown below, but Q is not limited thereto. For example, in a case where all the access points included in the multiple APs transmit “TRN” simultaneously and cooperatively, the discrete Fourier transformation (DFT) matrix or the Hadamard matrix shown below may be used for Q, but Q is not limited thereto.

[Math. 2]

$$(136) \quad Q = \begin{bmatrix} W_0^0 & W_0^1 & \dots & W_0^{N_{\text{DFT}}-1} \\ W_1^0 & W_1^1 & \dots & W_1^{N_{\text{DFT}}-1} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ W_{N_{\text{DFT}}-1}^0 & W_{N_{\text{DFT}}-1}^1 & \dots & W_{N_{\text{DFT}}-1}^{N_{\text{DFT}}-1} \end{bmatrix}, W_a^b = e^{-j2\pi \frac{a}{N_{\text{DFT}}} b} \quad \text{Formula2}$$

(137) Note that Q may not be a matrix determined separately from channel estimation information like that shown above, but may be a matrix determined on the basis of channel estimation information previously obtained by the multiple APs. For example, in a case where a candidate for the precoding vector for use is known among the multiple APs in advance, the candidate may be used.

(138) Further, Q may be expressed so that precoding can be implemented in a time division manner between the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**. Specifically, a matrix like below may be applied.

[Math. 3]

$$(139) \quad Q = \begin{bmatrix} Q_1 & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ 0 & Q_2 & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \dots & Q_{N_{\text{MultiAP}}} \end{bmatrix}, Q_i = [q_{i,1} \ q_{i,2} \ \dots \ q_{i,N_i}] \quad \text{Formula3}$$

(140) N.sub.MultiAP in the above formula represents the number of access points included in the multiple APs. Q.sub.i represents a precoding vector group applied only to the i-th access point included in the multiple APs. This Q.sub.i includes N.sub.i precoding vectors. rm in formula (1) above may be a value indicating the row number of Q.sub.m in Q. Note that Q.sub.i may be determined on the basis of a DFT matrix or an Hadamard matrix.

(141) Although formula (2) shows an example in which precoding is implemented in a cooperative manner by the multiple APs and formula (3) shows an example in which precoding is implemented in a time division manner in units of

individual access points included in the multiple APs, Q in which both are combined may be defined.

(142) [JT Interference Report]

(143) FIG. 9 is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of a JT interference report **823** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(144) The JT interference report **823** is used to announce the estimated amount of interference to the OBSS access point **203** from the OBSS terminal **209** that has received the JT interference scan **818** from the multiple APs. This frame includes “Frame Control”, “JT Interference Report Control element”, and “JT Interference Report element”, but is not limited thereto.

(145) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference report **823**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference report **823** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Report Control element” may be applied.

(146) The “JT Interference Report Control element” includes information for estimating each field length in the subsequent “JT Interference Report element” in advance, but is not limited thereto. This element includes at least one piece of information of “Frequency Band”, “Number of Observed Pieces of Precoding”, and “Reception Antenna Mask” in addition to “Element ID”.

(147) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating the frequency band of the estimated amount of interference. The “Number of Observed Pieces of Precoding” (Observed Precoding Number) includes information indicating the number of precoding vectors with which interference was estimated. The “Reception Antenna Mask” (RX Antenna Mask) includes information regarding the reception antenna of the OBSS terminal **209** used when interference was estimated. Note that the “Number of Observed Pieces of Precoding” may include information indicating the number of pieces of “Sector Information” in the subsequent “JT Interference Report element”.

(148) The “JT Interference Report element”, by being combined with the “JT Interference Report Control element”, indicates the amount of interference estimated by the JT interference scan **818**, but is not limited thereto. This element includes the following “Sector Information” in addition to “Element ID”.

(149) Each of the “Sector Information #1” (Sector Info. #1) to the “Sector Information #M” (Sector Info. #M) includes information regarding the respective observed precoding vector. Each piece of “Sector Information #i” includes the subfields of “Precoding ID #i” and “Interference Level #i”. The “Precoding ID” includes information indicating the observed precoding vector. The “Interference Level” includes information indicating the amount of interference of the observed precoding vector. The “Interference Level” may include, for example, information indicating a signal-to-noise ratio (SNR) in the observed frequency band or the intensity of a received signal.

(150) [JT Interference Feedback]

(151) FIG. 10 is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of JT interference feedback **824** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(152) The JT interference feedback **824** is used so that the OBSS-AP **203** that has received JT interference reports **823** from OBSS terminals **209** can announce information regarding the amount of interference estimated in all the OBSS terminals **209**. This frame includes “Frame Control”, “JT Interference Scan Control element”, and “JT Interference Feedback element” as shown below, but is not limited thereto.

(153) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference feedback **824**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference feedback **824** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Scan Control element” may be applied.

(154) The “JT Interference Scan Control element” includes information for estimating each field length in the subsequent “JT Interference Feedback element” in advance, but is not limited thereto. This element includes at least one or more of the fields of “Frequency Band”, and “Number of Pieces of Precoding” in addition to “Element ID”.

(155) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating the frequency band of the estimated amount of interference announced in the subsequent “JT Interference Feedback element”. The “Number of Pieces of Precoding” (Precoding Number) includes the number of precoding vectors of the estimated amount of interference announced in the subsequent “JT Interference Feedback element”. Note that the “Number of Pieces of Precoding” may include information indicating the number of “Sector Information” fields in the subsequent “JT Interference Feedback element”.

(156) The “JT Interference Feedback element”, by being combined with the “JT Interference Scan Control element”, indicates the amount of interference estimated in all OBSS terminals **209** from which JT interference reports **823** have been transmitted, but is not limited thereto. This element includes “Sector Information” in addition to “Element ID”.

(157) Each of the “Sector Information #1” (Sector Info. #1) to the “Sector Information #M” (Sector Info. #M) includes information indicating the estimated amount of interference in all OBSS terminals **209** from which the OBSS-AP **203** has received JT interference reports **823** for an arbitrary precoding vector among the precoding vectors used in the JT interference scan **818**. Each “Sector Information #i” field includes “Precoding ID #i”, “Interference Level #i”, and “Number of Interfered Terminals #i”, but the constituent components of the “Sector Information #i” field are not limited thereto.

(158) The “Precoding ID” includes information indicating a precoding vector referred to in the “Sector Information”. The “Interference Level” includes information indicating the amount of interference estimated by the OBSS terminal **209** for the precoding vector in question. The “Number of Interfered Terminals” (Interfered STA Num) includes information indicating the number of OBSS terminals **209** of which the estimated amount of interference exceed a certain threshold for the precoding vector in question.

(159) For example, in the “Sector Information #k”, the “Precoding ID #k” includes information indicating the k-th column precoding vector in the precoding matrix used in the JT interference scan **818**. Further, the “Interference Level #k” includes information indicating the total value of received powers exceeding a certain threshold among the received powers observed with the k-th column precoding vector in OBSS terminals **209**. The “Number of Interfered Terminals #k” includes information indicating the number of OBSS terminals **209** of which the received powers observed with the k-th column precoding vector exceed a certain threshold.

(160) [Joint Transmission Setting Announcement]

(161) FIG. **11** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of the joint transmission setting announcement **827** in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(162) The joint transmission setting announcement **827** is used so that after the master AP **101** that has received the JT interference feedback **824** from the OBSS-AP **203** determines one or more of a joint scheme in the multiple APs, a weighting factor in a joint scheme, a modulation and coding scheme (MCS), and transmission power on the basis of the received announcement information, the master AP **101** can announce the result to the slave AP **102**. Note that the information announced is not limited thereto. This frame includes “Frame Control”, “Multi AP Control”, “Joint Transmission element”, and “Null-Steering element”, but does not necessarily need to include all of them. For example, this frame may include either one of the “Joint Transmission element” and the “Null-Steering element” exclusively.

(163) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the joint transmission setting announcement **827**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the joint transmission setting announcement **827** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “Multi AP Control” may be applied.

(164) The “Multi AP Control” is used to notify the slave AP **102** of the joint scheme in the multiple APs. Note that the content of announcement by this field is not limited thereto. This field includes the subfield of “Multi AP Scheme”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto. Note that the “Multi AP Control” is an example of information regarding the number of joint wireless base stations mentioned in the claims.

(165) The “Multi AP Scheme” includes information indicating the joint scheme of the multiple APs. The “Multi AP Scheme” may include, for example, information indicating that not both of joint transmission and coordinated nulling are implemented or neither of them is implemented.

(166) The “Joint Transmission element” is used to announce a parameter necessary in a case where joint transmission is implemented by the multiple APs. This element includes one or more of the fields of “Joint Scheme”, “Slave AP Transmission Antenna Mask”, “Terminal Information”, and “Weight” in addition to “Element ID”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto.

(167) The “Joint Scheme” (JT Scheme) includes information indicating the joint scheme in joint transmission. The “Slave AP Transmission Antenna Mask” (Slave AP Tx Ant Mask) includes information indicating the transmission antenna that the slave AP **102** uses in a case where joint transmission is implemented. The “Terminal Information” (STA Info) includes information regarding the terminal of a destination of transmission by joint transmission in a case where joint transmission is implemented. The “Weight” includes information regarding the weighting factor and the transmission power used in the multiple APs in a case where joint transmission is implemented.

(168) Note that the “Weight” may include information indicating a weighting factor indicated in any format among compressed feedback, non-compressed feedback, and CSI feedback prescribed in IEEE 802.11 and information indicating parameters with which these pieces of information can be calculated as a weighting factor.

(169) Further, the “Terminal Information” may include one or more of the subfields of “Number of Terminals” and information corresponding to each terminal. The information corresponding to each terminal may include, for example, one or more of “Terminal ID”, “SS Number”, “Subcarrier Frequency Band”, “Transmission Power”, and “MCS”, but is not limited thereto.

(170) The “Number of Terminals” (STA Num) includes information indicating the number of terminals of destinations of transmission by joint transmission. Therefore, the following information includes N.sub.STA pieces of information, where N.sub.STA corresponds to the “Number of Terminals”.

(171) Each of the “Terminal ID #1” (AID #1) to the “Terminal ID #N.sub.STA” (AID #N.sub.STA) includes information indicating the respective destination terminal. Each of the “SS Number #1” (SS Num #1) to the “SS Number #N.sub.STA” (SS Num #N.sub.STA) includes information indicating the number of the stream allocated to the respective destination terminal. Each of the “Subcarrier Frequency Band #1” (BW #1) to the “Subcarrier Frequency Band #N.sub.STA” (BW #N.sub.STA) includes information indicating the frequency band allocated to the respective destination terminal. Each of the “Transmission Power #1” (Tx Power #1) to the “Transmission Power #N.sub.STA” (Tx Power #N.sub.STA) includes information indicating the transmission power allocated to the respective destination

terminal. Each of the “MCS #1” to the “MCS #N.sub.STA” includes information indicating the MCS allocated to the respective destination terminal. Note that, for a terminal to which a plurality of streams is allocated, the “MCS” may include information indicating the MCS of each stream.

(172) The fields and the subfields of the “Joint Transmission element” may include information like below.

(173) For example, the “Joint Scheme” may include information indicating which one of coherent joint transmission (CJT) and non-coherent joint transmission (NCJT) to execute. Further, the “Number of Terminals” may include at least one of the pieces of information indicating the numbers (N.sub.STA) of “Terminal ID” subfields, “SS Number” subfields, and “Subcarrier Frequency Band” subfields. Further, in a case where the “Joint Scheme” includes information indicating that CJT is to be executed, the “Transmission Power” may not be present.

(174) Further, for the k-th terminal of a destination of joint transmission, the “Terminal ID #k” may include a value determined by a MAC address. Further, the “SS Number #k” may include information by which a weighting factor can be obtained by additionally using the “Weight” field. Further, the “Subcarrier Frequency Band #k” may include information indicating the subcarrier allocated in joint transmission. Further, the “Transmission Power #k” may include information indicating the average value of transmission powers allocated to subcarriers individually.

(175) The “Null-Steering element” is used to announce a parameter necessary in a case where null-steering is implemented in the multiple APs. The null-steering is a communication scheme that forms a null for a not-desired communication terminal. This element includes at least one or more of the fields of “Slave AP Transmission Antenna Mask” and “Weight” in addition to “Element ID”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto.

(176) The “Weight” includes information indicating a vector that forms a null in a case where null-steering is implemented. The “Slave AP Transmission Antenna Mask” (Slave AP TX Ant Mask) includes information indicating the transmission antenna of the slave AP **102** when applying the vector indicated by the “Weight”.

(177) As a specific example, as shown in the following formula, when a vector P indicated by the “Weight” is expressed as a matrix by using p below, a precoding vector w implemented as null-steering in the slave AP **102** may be calculated as follows.

[Math. 4]

$$(178) \quad w \propto \max.\text{eigenvector}\left\{\left(\frac{2}{N}I + P^H P\right)^{-1} (H^H H)\right\} \quad \text{Formula 4} \quad s.t. P = [p_1 \ p_2 \ \dots \ p_{N_{\text{null}}}]$$

(179) Here, in the above formula, H is propagation path information estimated between a desired destination terminal (hereinafter, STA #3) of the slave AP **102** and the slave AP **102**. Further, $\sigma_{\text{sub.N.sup.2}}$ represents noise power that can be observed in the STA #3. Further, $A_{\text{sup.H}}$ represents a complex conjugate transposed matrix of the matrix A. Further, “max. eigenvector{A}” represents an eigenvector of the largest eigenvalue among the eigenvectors of the matrix A.

(180) [Processing Procedure]

(181) FIG. **12** is a flowchart showing a processing procedure example of weight determination processing in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(182) Herein, an operation in which the master AP **101** that has received the JT interference scan response **812** from the OBSS-AP **203** and has determined to implement the JT interference scan **818** determines a weight to be announced to the slave AP **102** in the JT scan sector information **813** is shown. The weight determined here corresponds to precoding used in the JT interference scan **818**.

(183) The master AP **101** that has determined to execute the JT interference scan **818** starts calculating a precoding matrix to be used in the JT interference scan **818**.

(184) First, it is determined whether or not to calculate precoding (a weight) of the JT interference scan on the basis of held channel state information (CSI, or propagation path information) (step S913). That is, it is determined whether or not CSI information between a terminal that can be a destination in the joint transmission **828** and the multiple APs has been obtained and a precoding matrix should be calculated on the basis of the CSI information.

(185) It is supposed that the JT interference scan **818** can be implemented by using a precoding matrix (hereinafter, referred to as known precoding or a codebook) predetermined among the multiple APs separately from CSI information. Hence, whether or not to use known precoding in the JT interference scan **818** may be determined by the implementation time of the JT interference scan **818**. For example, in a case where it is determined that the number of precoding vectors for a terminal of a destination in the joint transmission **828** is smaller than the number of known pieces of precoding, it may be determined to use precoding vectors calculated on the basis of CSI information without using known precoding.

(186) In a case where it is determined to use known precoding in the JT interference scan **818** (step S913: No), the master AP **101** stores, in the “Codebook Information” in the JT scan sector information **813**, information indicating that known precoding is to be used in the JT interference scan **818** (step S916). Then, information indicating a piece of precoding used in the JT interference scan **818** among known pieces of precoding is stored in the “Sector ID”.

(187) On the other hand, in a case where it is determined to implement the JT interference scan **818** by means of precoding calculated by using CSI information (step S913: Yes), the master AP **101** first calculates precoding to be applied in the JT interference scan **818** on the basis of CSI information (step S914). Then, the master AP **101** stores, in the “Codebook Information” in the JT scan sector information **813**, information indicating that the JT interference scan **818** is to be performed by using the calculated precoding (step S915).

(188) As a specific example, Q shown below may be applied as precoding, but the precoding is not limited thereto.

[Math. 5]

$Q=[q_{\text{sub}.1}, q_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots q_{\text{sub}.N_{\text{sub}.r}}]$, $S.t. q_{\text{sub}.i} \in \text{eigenvector}\{H_{\text{sup}.H} H\}$, $i \in [1, 2, \dots, N_{\text{sub}.r}]$ Formula 5
(189) H in the above formula is a propagation path matrix obtained by CSI information between the multiple APs and the terminal, and is a matrix having N_r or more columns.

(190) FIG. 13 is a flowchart showing a processing procedure example of joint transmission setting determination processing in the first embodiment of the present technology.

(191) Herein, the master AP 101 that has received the JT interference feedback 824 from the OBSS-AP 203 determines any one of a joint scheme, an MCS, and transmission power of the multiple APs in the joint transmission 828.

(192) The master AP 101 that has received the JT interference feedback 824 determines a joint transmission setting on the basis of the announced information of the estimated amount of interference in the OBSS terminal 209 (step S921).

(193) First, whether or not CJT can be implemented is determined on the basis of whether or not, in a case where CJT is implemented, the amount of interference with the OBSS terminal 209 exceeds a threshold (step S922). Specifically, the amount of interference of the OBSS terminal 209 is estimated for a weight of CJT determined as described later. The weight of CJT may be calculated on the basis of CSI information between the multiple APs and the OBSS terminal 209, and may be obtained by Singular Vector Decomposition (SVD), Minimize Maximum Square Error (MMSE), the water filling theorem, or the like. Note that the weight is expressed by a complex number, and the norm of the weight means transmission power.

(194) In a case where it is determined to implement CJT (step S922: No), an MCS is calculated for the weight of CJT (step S928), and the weight of CJT and the MCS are announced to the slave AP 102 by the joint transmission setting announcement 827 (step S929).

(195) On the other hand, in a case where it is determined not to implement CJT (step S922: Yes), it is determined whether or not NCJT can be implemented (step S923). Specifically, as described later, a weight of NCJT is determined, and the amount of interference of the OBSS terminal 209 for the weight is estimated. In a case where it is determined to implement NCJT (step S923: No), an MCS is calculated for the weight of NCJT (step S926), and the weight of NCJT and the MCS are announced to the slave AP 102 by the joint transmission setting announcement 827 (step S927).

(196) In a case where it is determined not to implement NCJT (step S923: Yes), it is determined that the joint transmission 828 is to be implemented by non-joint transmission (non-JT). Note that also in non-JT, a scheme of non-JT is determined including whether or not to implement coordinated nulling.

(197) As to whether or not coordinated nulling can be implemented, the following method may be used: the number of reception antennas of all destination terminals used in the joint transmission 828 and the total number of transmission antennas of the multiple APs are compared; in a case where the total number of transmission antennas of the multiple APs is larger, coordinated nulling is implemented; in other cases, precoding calculated by Zero Forcing (ZF), Minimize Maximum Square Error (MMSE), or the like is used.

(198) In a case where it is determined to implement Non-JT (step S923: Yes), an MCS is calculated for the weight of Non-JT (step S924), and the weight of Non-JT and the MCS are announced to the slave AP 102 by the joint transmission setting announcement 827 (step S925).

(199) As a specific example of the above-described determination of whether or not CJT or NCJT can be implemented, the determination can be made as follows. Herein, the value of the total amount of interference of OBSS terminals 209 for, among the precoding vectors implemented in the JT interference scan 818, the k -th precoding vector that has been precoded in a cooperative manner among the multiple APs is represented by $I_{\text{sub}.CJT.\text{sup}.(k)}$. Further, the value of the total amount of interference of OBSS terminals 209 for the l -th precoding vector of the m -th access point that, without cooperation among the multiple APs, has been precoded in a time division manner in units of individual access points included in the multiple APs is represented by $I_{\text{sub}.NCJT.\text{sup}.(m,l)}$. Further, the thresholds are represented by $I_{\text{sub}.Thr}$ and $I_{\text{sub}.Thr'}$. Note that each of $I_{\text{sub}.CJT.\text{sup}.(k)}$ and $I_{\text{sub}.NCJT.\text{sup}.(m,l)}$ is information indicated by the “Sector Information” field in the JT interference feedback 824 from the OBSS-AP 203.

(200) As a criterion for implementing CJT, it may be determined to implement CJT when the following is satisfied.

[Math. 6]

$$(201) \max_j [\text{Math. } a_{i,j} \cdot \text{Math. } ^2] > I_{\text{Thr}} \cdot s.t. \{a_{i,j}\} = A = \text{diag}[I_{\text{CJT}}^{(l)} \cdot \text{Math. } I_{\text{CJT}}^{(Nr)}] [q_{\text{CJT}}^{(1)H} \dots q_{\text{CJT}}^{(Nr)H}] W_{\text{CJT}} \quad \text{Formula 6}$$

(202) Here, $W_{\text{sub}.CJT}$ represents a precoding matrix in a case where CJT is implemented. Further, $\text{diag}[\]$ represents a diagonal matrix in which each element is a diagonal component. Further, $N_{\text{sub}.T}$ is the maximum value of k announced by the JT interference scan 818.

(203) Further, as another example, it may be determined to implement CJT when the following formula is satisfied instead of the above formula.

[Math . 7]

$$(204) \quad \text{Math. } a_{i,j}^2 > I_{\text{Thr}} \text{ s.t. } \{a_{i,j}\} = A = \text{diag}[I_{\text{CJT}}^{(l)} \text{ Math. } I_{\text{CJT}}^{(\text{Nr})}] \left[\begin{matrix} q_{\text{CJT}}^{(1)H} \\ \vdots \\ q_{\text{CJT}}^{(N_r)H} \end{matrix} \right] W_{\text{CJT}} \quad \text{Formula7}$$

(205) As a criterion for implementing NCJT, it may be determined to implement NCJT when the following is satisfied.

(206)

[Math . 8]

$$\max[\text{Math. } b_{i,j}^{(m)2}] > I_{\text{Thr}} \text{ s.t. } \{b_{i,j}^{(m)}\} = B^{(m)} = \text{diag}[I_{\text{NCJT}}^{(m,1)} \text{ Math. } I_{\text{CJT}}^{(m,N_T(m))}] \left[\begin{matrix} q_{\text{CJT}}^{(1)H} \\ \vdots \\ q_{\text{CJT}}^{(N_T)H} \end{matrix} \right] W_{\text{NCJT}}^{(m)} \quad \text{Formula8}$$

(207) Here, $W_{\text{sub.NCJT.sup.}(m)}$ represents a precoding matrix of the m-th access point included in the multiple APs in a case where NCJT is implemented. Further, $N_{\text{sub.T.sup.}(m)}$ is the maximum value of l in the m-th access point announced by the JT interference scan **818**.

(208) Further, as another example, it may be determined to implement NCJT when the following formula is satisfied instead of the above formula.

(209)

[Math . 9]

$$\text{Math. } b_{i,j}^{(m)2} > I_{\text{Thr}} \text{ s.t. } \{b_{i,j}^{(m)}\} = B^{(m)} = \text{diag}[I_{\text{NCJT}}^{(m,1)} \text{ Math. } I_{\text{CJT}}^{(m,N_T(m))}] \left[\begin{matrix} q_{\text{CJT}}^{(1)H} \\ \vdots \\ q_{\text{CJT}}^{(N_T)H} \end{matrix} \right] W_{\text{NCJT}}^{(m)} \quad \text{Formula9}$$

(210) Note that the criteria for implementing CJT or NCJT shown in the above formulae are examples of a predetermined criterion mentioned in the claims.

(211) Thus, according to the first embodiment of the present technology, interference caused by joint transmission can be estimated in the OBSS terminal **209** by transmitting a reference signal (TRN) at the time of the JT interference scan **818**.

2. Second Embodiment

(212) In the first embodiment described above, it is supposed that CSI information has already been obtained; in a second embodiment described here, it is supposed that CSI information of the wireless terminal **109** is estimated at the time of the JT interference scan **818**. Note that the configurations of the wireless network system and the wireless communication apparatus are similar to those of the first embodiment described above, and thus a detailed description thereof is omitted.

(213) [Operation]

(214) FIG. **14** is a sequence diagram showing an operation example of a wireless network system in a second embodiment of the present technology.

(215) The operation in the second embodiment is basically similar to that in the first embodiment described above, but differs in the following points.

(216) [JT Interference Scan Trigger]

(217) In a case where the master AP **101** that has received Ack **814** from the slave AP **102** has determined that now it is near the start time of interference measurement, the master AP, when executing, on the OBSS-AP **203**, a JT interference scan trigger indicating that interference measurement is to be implemented, transmits such a trigger also to the wireless terminal **109**. The frame announced by the JT interference scan trigger **831** is similar to that in the first embodiment described above, but the wireless terminal **109** that has received the JT interference scan trigger **831** is set such that propagation path information can be estimated at the time at which a JT interference scan **832** is announced. The time at which the JT interference scan **832** is announced is determined by information included in the “Scan Start Time” in the JT interference scan trigger **831**.

(218) [JT Interference Scan]

(219) After the JT interference scan trigger **831** indicating that interference measurement is to be implemented is executed on the OBSS-AP **203**, the multiple APs that have determined that now it is time to start interference measurement announce the JT interference scan **832** to, in addition to the OBSS terminal **209** of the first embodiment described above, the wireless terminal **109** in the second embodiment.

(220) The wireless terminal **109** that has received a reference signal from the multiple APs by means of the JT interference scan **832** estimates propagation path (channel) information (**833**). Further, unlike in the OBSS terminal **209**, although propagation path information may be estimated for each piece of precoding, propagation path information may be estimated on the basis of “EHT-LTF”, which is a reference signal section to which precoding is not applied.

(221) [Channel Feedback]

(222) The wireless terminal **109** to which the JT interference scan **832** has been announced from the multiple APs notifies the multiple APs of the estimated propagation path information by means of channel feedback **834**. The timing of the channel feedback **834** may be determined on the basis of the reception of the JT interference scan trigger **831**, or the channel feedback **834** may be implemented when it is determined that the JT interference scan **832** is ended.

(223) [Frame Configuration]

(224) In the following, the configurations of the frames added in the second embodiment are described in detail.

(225) [JT Interference Scan Trigger]

(226) FIG. **15** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of the JT interference scan trigger **831** in the second embodiment of the present technology.

(227) The frame of the JT interference scan trigger **831** in the second embodiment is basically similar to the JT interference scan trigger **815** in the first embodiment described above. However, in a case where, unlike in the first embodiment, channel estimation of the wireless terminal **109** is performed simultaneously with the estimation of the amount of interference of the OBSS terminal **209** by the JT interference scan trigger **831**, the value indicated by the “Frame Control” may be different from that in a case where only the estimation of the amount of interference of the OBSS terminal **209** is performed. This is because in a case where the frame announced by the JT interference scan trigger **831** does not include information for determining whether or not the wireless terminal **109** should perform channel estimation, it is necessary to notify the wireless terminal **109** by means of the immediately preceding JT interference scan trigger **831** that channel estimation is to be performed by the subsequent JT interference scan **832**. Note that a configuration in which, by combining the “Frame Control” and other information in this frame, the wireless terminal **109** can understand that channel estimation is to be performed by the subsequent JT interference scan **832** may be applied.

(228) Further, in the “JT Interference Scan Information”, “Feedback Execution Time” (Feedback Timing) is added as compared to the first embodiment described above. The “Feedback Execution Time” includes information indicating, to the wireless terminal **109**, the time to execute the channel feedback **834**. The “Feedback Execution Time” may include information indicating that the feedback is to be executed after a lapse of a certain period of time from when the “JT Interference Scan Information” is ended or information indicating that the feedback is to be executed after a trigger **817** is announced from the multiple APs.

(229) [Channel Feedback]

(230) FIG. **16** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of channel feedback **834** in the second embodiment of the present technology.

(231) The frame of the channel feedback **834** is used when announcing, from the wireless terminal **109** to the multiple APs, propagation path information estimated by the JT interference scan **832**. This frame includes “Frame Control”, “Channel Feedback Control element”, and “Channel Feedback Information element”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto. Further, each element does not necessarily need to be defined independently, and may be combined with another constituent component and defined as one element.

(232) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the channel feedback **834**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is a frame to be notified as the channel feedback **834** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “Channel Feedback Control element” may be applied.

(233) The “Channel Feedback Control element” includes information for estimating each field length in the subsequent “Channel Feedback Information element” in advance, but is not limited thereto. This element includes at least one or more of the pieces of information of “Frequency Band”, and “Feedback Control” in addition to “Element ID”.

(234) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating the frequency band of the estimated propagation path information. The “Feedback Control” includes information indicating the format, etc. of propagation path information included in the subsequent “Channel Feedback Information element”. The “Feedback Control” includes at least one or more of the subfields of “Number of Rounds of Measurement”, “Terminal Antenna Mask”, and “Quantization Granularity”.

(235) The “Number of Rounds of Measurement” (Measurement Number) includes information indicating that the estimated propagation path information includes propagation path information estimated in a case where the multiple APs have cooperatively performed transmission or propagation path information estimated in units of individual access points included in the multiple APs, or includes both. The “Terminal Antenna Mask” (STA Ant Mask) includes information indicating the reception antenna of the wireless terminal **109** used to estimate propagation path information. The “Quantization Granularity” includes information indicating how many bits of information each numerical value included in precoding is expressed by.

(236) Note that the multiple APs that have received the channel feedback **834** may determine whether or not “CJT Channel Measurement” or “NCJT Channel Measurement”, or both are present in the subsequent “Channel Feedback Information element” on the basis of information stored in the “Number of Rounds of Measurement”. Further, in a case where it is indicated that propagation path information estimated in units of individual access points included in the multiple APs is included, also information indicating the access points used in the estimation may be included.

(237) The “Channel Feedback Information element”, by being combined with the “Channel Feedback Control element”, indicates propagation path information estimated by the JT interference scan **832**. Note that the information included in the “Channel Feedback Information element” is not limited thereto. This element includes at least one or more of the pieces of information of “CJT Channel Measurement” and “NCJT Channel Measurement” in addition to “Element ID”. (238) The “CJT Channel Measurement” includes propagation path estimation information for a reference signal that the multiple APs that have implemented the JT interference scan **832** have cooperatively transmitted; for example, may include propagation path estimation information related to a JT interference scan **832** implemented in accordance with formula 2. The “NCJT Channel Measurement” includes propagation path estimation information for reference signals that the multiple APs that have implemented the JT interference scan **832** have transmitted in units of individual access points included in the multiple APs; for example, may include propagation path estimation information related to a JT interference scan **832** implemented in accordance with formula 3. The “NCJT Channel Measurement” includes the subfields of “CSI AP Set #1” to “CSI AP Set #N.sub.SET”.

(239) Each of the “CSI AP Set #1” to the “CSI AP Set #N.sub.SET” includes propagation path estimation information for an arbitrary combination of access points included in the multiple APs and information indicating the combination. The information indicating a combination of access points may not be included. For example, the information indicating a combination of access points may not be included in a case where it is indicated in the “Channel Feedback Information element” that each “CSI AP Set” includes propagation path estimation information obtained in units of individual access points included in the multiple APs.

(240) [Processing Procedure]

(241) FIG. **17** is a flowchart showing a processing procedure example of weight determination processing in the second embodiment of the present technology.

(242) The master AP **101** that has determined to execute the JT interference scan **832** starts calculating a precoding to be used in the JT interference scan **832**.

(243) Here, it is determined whether or not valid propagation path estimation information between a wireless terminal **109** that can be a destination in joint transmission and the multiple APs is held. Specifically, it is determined whether or not no propagation path estimation information is held or whether or not the held propagation path estimation information was acquired a certain period of time or more ago (step **S911**).

(244) In a case where it is determined that valid propagation path estimation information is not held (step **S911**: No), it is determined whether or not to implement, on the wireless terminal **109**, the estimation (sounding) of propagation path information by the JT interference scan **832** (step **S912**).

(245) In a case where sounding is to be implemented (step **S912**: Yes), the slave AP **102** is notified by the JT scan sector information **813** that sounding is to be implemented by using known precoding in the JT interference scan **832** (step **S916**).

(246) On the other hand, in a case where it is determined that sounding is not to be implemented by the JT interference scan **832** (step **S912**: No), it is determined whether or not to implement the JT interference scan **832** by using known precoding (step **S913**). The subsequent operation is similar to that of the first embodiment described above.

(247) Thus, according to the second embodiment of the present technology, by transmitting the JT interference scan **832** also to the wireless terminal **109**, channel estimation can be performed in the wireless terminal **109** in parallel with interference estimation in the OBSS terminal **209**.

3. Third Embodiment

(248) In the first embodiment described above, it is supposed that the JT interference scan **818** is implemented with the JT interference scan announcement **811** from the multiple APs as an opportunity; in a third embodiment described here, it is supposed that the OBSS-AP **203** first notifies the multiple APs. Note that the configurations of the wireless network system and the wireless communication apparatus are similar to those of the first embodiment described above, and thus a detailed description thereof is omitted.

(249) [Operation]

(250) FIG. **18** is a sequence diagram showing an operation example of a wireless network system in a third embodiment of the present technology.

(251) The operation in the third embodiment is basically similar to that in the first embodiment described above, but differs in the following points.

(252) [JT Interference Scan Request]

(253) First, the OBSS-AP **203** implements, on the multiple APs, a JT interference scan request **841** that requests the execution of the JT interference scan **818**. At this time, information indicating a start time and an execution period of interference measurement requested by the OBSS-AP **203** may be included in the announcement. The JT interference scan request **841** is announced to at least one of the master AP **101** or the slave AP **102** among the multiple APs. Note that the JT interference scan request **841** is an example of a communication section mentioned in the claims.

(254) Note that in a case where the JT interference scan request **841** has been announced only to the slave AP **102**, the slave AP **102** may notify the master AP **101** of information indicating that the JT interference scan request **841** has been announced from the OBSS-AP **203**. Further, information indicating that the slave AP **102** and the master AP **101** are to exchange each other's roles may be announced, and the roles of the slave AP **102** and the master AP **101** may be exchanged.

(255) For example, in a case where the OBSS-AP **203** recognizes the presence of the multiple APs and the quality of transmission to the OBSS terminal **209** is determined to be poor, or in a case where the OBSS-AP **203** recognizes the presence of the multiple APs and the received power of a signal transmitted by the multiple APs is higher than a threshold, the OBSS-AP **203** may operate to execute the JT interference scan request **841**.

(256) [JT Interference Scan Announcement]

(257) In a case where the JT interference scan request **841** has been executed from the OBSS-AP **203**, the multiple APs execute, on the OBSS-AP **203**, a JT interference scan announcement **842** regarding the start time and the execution period for executing interference measurement. Note that the information announced is not limited thereto.

(258) Although this example shows a case where the master AP **101** executes the JT interference scan announcement **842** on the OBSS-AP **203**, the JT interference scan announcement **842** may be executed by the slave AP **102** or the multiple APs (both the master AP **101** and the slave AP **102**) instead of the master AP **101**.

(259) [Frame Configuration]

(260) In the following, the configurations of the frames added in the third embodiment are described in detail.

(261) [JT Interference Scan Request]

(262) FIG. **19** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of the JT interference scan request **841** in the third embodiment of the present technology.

(263) The frame of the JT interference scan request **841** is a frame with which the OBSS-AP **203** requests the multiple APs to announce, from the multiple APs to the OBSS-AP **203**, a request to implement interference measurement and a request for the start time and the execution period of interference measurement. This frame includes “Frame Control” and “JT Interference Scan Request element”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto.

(264) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference scan request **841**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference scan request **841** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Scan Request element” may be applied.

(265) The “JT Interference Scan Request element” includes information regarding a start time and an execution time of interference measurement that the OBSS-AP **203** requests of the multiple APs. This element includes at least one or more of the fields of “Frequency Band”, “Number of Terminals”, “Scan Request”, “Scan Start Time”, and “Scan Execution Period” in addition to “Element ID”.

(266) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information in which the OBSS-AP **203** presents, to the multiple APs, a request value of the bandwidth used when implementing interference measurement. The “Number of Terminals” (STA Number) includes information regarding the number of OBSS-APs **203**. The “Scan Request” includes information indicating that it is the JT interference scan request **841**. The “Scan Start Time” includes information regarding an execution start time of the JT interference scan **818** that the OBSS-AP **203** requests of the multiple APs. The “Scan Execution Period” (Scan Duration) includes information regarding an execution period of the JT interference scan **818** that the OBSS-AP **203** requests of the multiple APs.

(267) [JT Interference Scan Announcement]

(268) FIG. **20** is a diagram showing a frame configuration example of the JT interference scan announcement **842** in the third embodiment of the present technology.

(269) The frame of the JT interference scan announcement **842** is used when the multiple APs on which the JT interference scan request **841** has been implemented from the OBSS-AP **203** announce information regarding the JT interference scan **818**, such as the start time and the execution period of the JT interference scan **818** implemented later, on the basis of information announced to the OBSS-AP **203**. This frame includes “Frame Control” and “JT Interference Scan Announcement element”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto.

(270) The “Frame Control” includes information indicating that this frame is a frame announced as the JT interference scan announcement **842**. However, it is not necessary that such information be included in the “Frame Control” alone, and a configuration in which the fact that this frame is the JT interference scan announcement **842** is indicated by additionally using other information in this frame may be applied. For example, a configuration in which an interpretation can be made by additionally using a value of an arbitrary field in the “JT Interference Scan Announcement element” may be applied.

(271) The “JT Interference Scan Announcement element” includes information regarding a start time and an execution time of interference measurement that the OBSS-AP **203** requests of the multiple APs. This element includes at least one or more of the fields of “Frequency Band”, “Scan Start Time”, and “Scan Execution Period” in addition to “Element ID”, but the constituent components are not limited thereto.

(272) The “Frequency Band” (BW) includes information indicating the bandwidth used when the multiple APs implement interference measurement on the OBSS-AP **203**. The “Scan Start Time” includes information regarding the execution start time of the JT interference scan **818** of the multiple APs. The “Scan Execution Period” (Scan Duration) includes information regarding the execution period of the JT interference scan **818** of the multiple APs.

(273) Thus, according to the third embodiment of the present technology, the JT interference scan **818** can be performed with the JT interference scan request **841** from the OBSS-AP **203** as an opportunity.

(274) Note that the above embodiments show examples for embodying the present technology, and the matters in the

embodiments and the invention-defining matters in the claims have respective correspondence relationships. Similarly, the invention-defining matters in the claims and the matters given the same names as these in the embodiments of the present technology have respective correspondence relationships. However, the present technology is not limited to the embodiments, and may be embodied by making various modifications to the embodiments without departing from the gist of the present technology.

(275) Further, each of the processing procedures described in the above embodiments may be grasped as a method including these series of steps, or may be grasped as a program for causing a computer to execute these series of steps or a recording medium storing the program. As the recording medium, for example, a compact disc (CD), a MiniDisc (MD), a digital versatile disc (DVD), a memory card, a Blu-ray (registered trademark) disc, or the like may be used.

(276) Note that the effects described in the present specification are only examples and are not limitative ones, and there may be other effects.

(277) Additionally, the present technology may also be configured as below.

(278) (1) A wireless base station including:

(279) a wireless control section that generates and transmits a reference signal for estimating interference that is, when performing joint transmission with a joint wireless base station, given to a wireless terminal connected to another wireless base station and determines a setting regarding the joint transmission in accordance with a result of estimation of the interference based on the reference signal; and

(280) a communication section that transmits the reference signal to the another wireless base station or the wireless terminal and announces the setting regarding the joint transmission to the joint wireless base station.

(281) (2) The wireless base station according to the (1), in which

(282) the wireless control section inquires of the another wireless base station whether or not measurement for estimation of the interference can be performed prior to transmission of the reference signal.

(283) (3) The wireless base station according to the (1) or (2), in which

(284) the wireless control section generates information regarding precoding of the reference signal, and

(285) the communication section transmits the information regarding precoding of the reference signal to the joint wireless base station.

(286) (4) The wireless base station according to the (3), in which

(287) the information regarding precoding includes information regarding a frequency at which the reference signal is used.

(288) (5) The wireless base station according to the (3) or (4), in which

(289) the information regarding precoding includes information regarding a codebook predetermined with the joint wireless base station.

(290) (6) The wireless base station according to any one of the (3) to (5), in which

(291) the information regarding precoding includes information regarding a weighting factor to be calculated to the reference signal.

(292) (7) The wireless base station according to any one of the (3) to (6), in which

(293) the information regarding precoding includes information regarding a time offset for the joint wireless base station at a time of transmission of the reference signal.

(294) (8) The wireless base station according to the (7), in which

(295) the information regarding precoding includes at least one of pieces of information indicating presence or absence of the time offset or information indicating the time offset.

(296) (9) The wireless base station according to any one of the (1) to (8), in which

(297) the wireless control section, prior to transmission of the reference signal, generates information indicating that measurement for estimation of the interference is to be implemented, and

(298) the communication section transmits, to the another wireless base station, the information indicating that measurement for estimation of the interference is to be implemented.

(299) (10) The wireless base station according to the (9), in which

(300) the information indicating that measurement for estimation of the interference is to be implemented includes information regarding a time to transmit the reference signal, an implementation period of the measurement, and a frequency at which the measurement is implemented.

(301) (11) The wireless base station according to any one of the (1) to (10), in which

(302) the wireless control section determines a joint parameter including at least one of a joint transmission scheme, precoding, an encoding scheme, or transmission power in the joint transmission on the basis of a result of estimation of the interference from the another wireless base station.

(303) (12) The wireless base station according to the (11), in which

(304) the joint parameter is determined on the basis of a predetermined criterion.

(305) (13) The wireless base station according to any one of the (1) to (12), in which

(306) the reference signal includes information for estimating a propagation path between the wireless base station and a wireless terminal connected to the wireless base station, and

(307) the communication section transmits the reference signal to the wireless terminal connected to the wireless base station.

(308) (14) The wireless base station according to any one of the (1) to (13), in which
 (309) the setting of the joint transmission announced by the joint transmission setting announcement section includes information regarding a number of the joint wireless base stations.
 (310) (15) The wireless base station according to the (14), in which
 (311) the setting of the joint transmission announced by the communication section further includes at least one of information regarding a joint transmission scheme in the joint transmission, information regarding a transmission antenna to be used in the joint wireless base station, information regarding the wireless terminal of a destination in the joint transmission, or information regarding precoding of the wireless terminal of a destination in the joint transmission.
 (312) (16) The wireless base station according to the (15), in which
 (313) the information regarding precoding of the wireless terminal of a destination in the joint transmission includes information regarding a number of the wireless terminals of destinations, information that identifies the wireless terminal of a destination, and information regarding a frequency, an encoding scheme, transmission power, and a stream to be used in the joint transmission.
 (314) (17) A wireless base station including:
 (315) a wireless control section that acquires, from a wireless terminal, information regarding interference with the wireless terminal caused by joint transmission, the interference having been estimated by using a reference signal supplied from any one of a plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission, and generates overall interference information on the basis of the acquired information regarding the interference; and
 (316) a communication section that transmits the overall interference information to any one of the plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission.
 (317) (18) The wireless base station according to the (17), in which
 (318) the communication section requests each of the plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission to transmit a reference signal for estimating interference given to the wireless terminal because of the joint transmission.
 (319) (19) A wireless terminal including:
 (320) a wireless control section that estimates interference received because of joint transmission by using a reference signal supplied from any one of a plurality of wireless base stations that performs the joint transmission; and
 (321) a communication section that transmits information regarding the estimated interference to another wireless base station.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(322) **101** Master access point **102** Slave access point **108** to **109** Wireless terminal **203** OBSS access point **209** OBSS terminal **300** Wireless communication apparatus **310** Communication section **311** Wireless control section **312** Data processing section **313** Modulation/demodulation section **314** Signal processing section **315** Channel estimation section **316** Wireless interface section **317** Amplifier section **319** Antenna **321** Control section **322** Power source section **811** JT interference scan announcement **812** JT interference scan response **813** JT scan sector information **815** JT interference scan trigger **816** OBSS JT interference scan announcement **817** Trigger **818** JT interference scan **821** Estimation of the amount of interference **822** JT interference report trigger **823** JT interference report **824** JT interference feedback **826** Joint transmission setting determination **827** Joint transmission setting announcement **828** Joint transmission **831** JT interference scan trigger **832** JT interference scan **834** Channel Feedback **841** JT interference scan request **842** JT interference scan announcement

Claims

1. A wireless communication control apparatus configured to control wireless communication of a first wireless base station, comprising: circuitry configured to: control a wireless communication circuitry of the first wireless base station to perform joint transmission with a second wireless base station; control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit a reference signal to at least one of a third wireless base station or a first wireless terminal, wherein the first wireless terminal receives the transmitted reference signal, the first wireless terminal estimates an amount of interference based on the received reference signal, the first wireless base station and the second wireless base station are associated with a first basic service set (BSS), the third wireless bases station and the first wireless terminal are associated with a second BSS different from the first BSS, and a coverage area of the first BSS overlaps with a coverage area of the second BSS; control the wireless communication circuitry to receive, from the third wireless base station, a result of the estimation of the amount of the interference, determine, based on the received result, a setting associated with the joint transmission; and control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit the setting to the second wireless base station.
2. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the circuitry is further configured control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit, to the third wireless base station, an inquiry to inquire that the estimation of the amount of the interference is prior to the transmission of the reference signal.
3. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the circuitry is further configured to: generate first information associated with precoding of the reference signal; and control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit the generated first information to the second wireless base station.

4. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 3, wherein the generated first information includes second information associated with a frequency of usage of the reference signal.

5. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 3, wherein the generated first information includes second information associated with a specific codebook of the second wireless base station.

6. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 3, wherein the generated first information includes second information associated with a weighting factor for the estimation of the amount of the interference.

7. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 3, wherein the generated first information includes information associated with a time offset for the second wireless base station at a time of the transmission of the reference signal.

8. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 7, wherein the generated first information includes at least one of third information that indicates one of a presence or an absence of the time offset, or fourth information that indicates the time offset.

9. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the circuitry is further configured to: generate, prior to the transmission of the reference signal, information that indicates an implementation of the estimation of the amount of the interference; and control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit the generated information to the third wireless base station.

10. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 9, wherein the generated information includes a time of the transmission of the reference signal, an implementation period of the estimation of the amount of the interference, and a frequency to implement the estimation of the amount of the interference.

11. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the circuitry is further configured to determine, based on the received result, a joint parameter that includes at least one of a joint transmission scheme, a precoding for the joint transmission, an encoding scheme, or a transmission power in the joint transmission.

12. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 11, wherein the circuitry is further configured to determine the joint parameter further based on specific criterion.

13. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the reference signal includes information for estimation of a propagation path between the first wireless base station and a second wireless terminal connected to the first wireless base station, the circuitry is further configured to control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit the reference signal to the second wireless terminal, and the second wireless terminal is associated with the first BSS.

14. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the determined setting includes information associated with a number of a plurality of joint wireless base stations, the plurality of joint wireless base stations includes the second wireless base station, the plurality of joint wireless base stations is different from the third wireless base station, and the first wireless base station performs the joint transmission with the plurality of joint wireless base stations.

15. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 14, wherein the setting further includes at least one of information associated with a joint transmission scheme in the joint transmission, information associated with a transmission antenna of the second wireless base station, information associated with a second wireless terminal, or information associated with a precoding of the second wireless terminal, and the second wireless terminal corresponds to a destination of the joint transmission.

16. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 15, wherein the information associated with the precoding of the second wireless terminal includes a number of a plurality of wireless terminals, identification information of the second wireless terminal, frequency information, an encoding scheme, transmission power, and a stream for the joint transmission, each the plurality of wireless terminals corresponds to the destination of the joint transmission, the plurality of wireless terminals includes the second wireless terminal, and the first wireless terminal is different from the plurality of wireless terminals.

17. A wireless communication control apparatus configured to control wireless communication of a wireless base station, comprising: circuitry configured to: control a wireless communication circuitry of the wireless base station to receive, from a wireless terminal, information of interference with the wireless terminal, wherein the wireless terminal estimates the interference based on a reference signal from one of a plurality of wireless base stations, the plurality of wireless base stations performs joint transmission, the interference is based on the joint transmission, the plurality of wireless base stations is different from the wireless base station, the plurality of wireless base stations is associated with a first basic service set (BSS), the wireless base station and the wireless terminal are associated with a second (BSS) different from the first BSS, and a coverage area of the first BSS overlaps with a coverage area of the second BSS; generate overall interference information based on the received information; and control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit the generated overall interference information to the one of the plurality of wireless base stations.

18. The wireless communication control apparatus according to claim 17, wherein the circuitry is further configured to control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit, to each of the plurality of wireless base stations, a request to transmit the reference signal.

19. A wireless communication control apparatus configured to control wireless communication of a wireless terminal, comprising: circuitry configured to: control a wireless communication circuitry of the wireless terminal to receive a reference signal from one of a plurality of wireless base stations, wherein the plurality of wireless base stations performs

joint transmission; estimate, based on the received reference signal, an amount of interference by the joint transmission; and control the wireless communication circuitry to transmit, to a wireless base station, information that indicates the estimated amount of the interference, wherein the plurality of wireless base stations is different from the wireless base station, the plurality of wireless base stations is associated with a first basic service set (BSS), the wireless base station and the wireless terminal are associated with a second (BSS) different from the first BSS, and a coverage area of the first BSS overlaps with a coverage area of the second BSS.
